AI policy and the class metascience project

Psych 251 · Monday, November 2

1 Suggested AI policies and norms 2 The class metascience project

AI use: these slides were drafted with Claude Code (Anthropic) from our metascience planning document and the post “My lab’s AI policies and norms” (October 2026), at Mike’s direction.

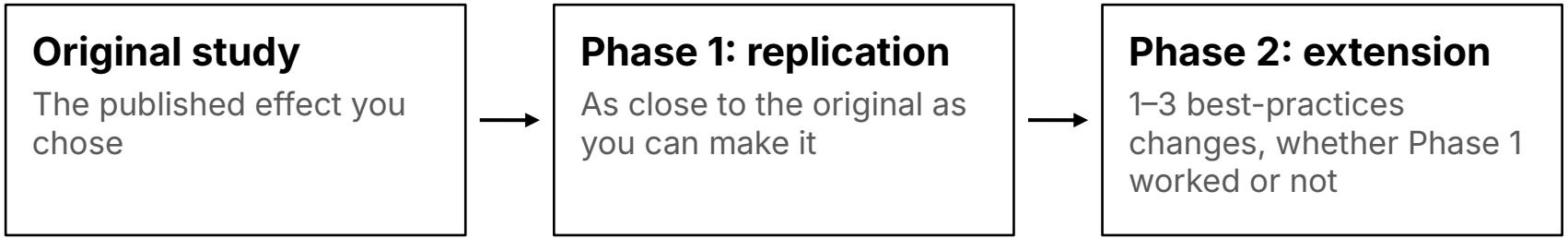
Suggested AI policies

You write the text	Your proposal and report are written by you. Agents can write code, documentation and admin.
Always disclose	Every submission has an AI use statement, even if you used none: what for, and which model and version.
Agent review last	After your own read-through, have an agent review your work. Consider every suggestion; keep what you can defend.
Protect participants	No Prolific IDs or other identifiers in a commercial model. Free text, audio and video only under a no-training agreement.
Respect others' work	Don't put a manuscript you are reviewing, or a classmate's work, into a model unless that is allowed.

Suggested AI norms

Engineer it	Version control, tests for reusable code, an organized project, clear documentation (Poldrack, Better Code, Better Science).
Mark AI text you share	Quote it when you paste it into Slack, so nobody mistakes it for your own words.
Don’t send slop	Condense before you share, by hand or with AI. If something is unpolished, say so.
Read the paper first	Struggle with it yourself before asking a model about it; you will remember more.
Avoid the slop cliff	Keep understanding your own project: check details, ask follow-ups, and treat a surprising answer as a reason to dig in.

Class metascience: the proposal



The question

Do changes drawn from Experimentology (measurement, design, sample, checks) make a replication more successful, and recover more of the original effect?

Who's in

- Opted-in projects: extra budget, and every opted-in student is an author
- Track 1 only; scientific extensions (Track 2) are excluded
- We expect about 15–20 projects

What we will measure

Replication success

Course staff rate each phase against the original, from 0 to 1. A score of .75 or more counts as a success.

Effect size ratio

Your effect divided by the original effect, both as standardized mean differences. We compute it by re-running your analysis on the data in your repository.

How we compare

Phase 2 against Phase 1, pooled across every project. Boyce et al. (2024) found that 5 of 17 rescues of failed class replications (29%) mostly or fully replicated; we will set our results beside theirs, but the studies differ too much for a formal comparison.

Also: precision (how much the standard error shrank, beyond what sample size alone explains).

Choice points

Staff ratings of replication success

All four of us rate every project: during presentations, or from your report if the data were not in yet.

Rescue or upgrade: who decides?

Is there really a difference?

Ambiguity ratings

How systematic should they be, and what system do we use?

Agent reproducibility audits

When do they happen, and who runs and checks them?

Attitudes, chat logs, comprehension quiz

These study you rather than your experiments, so they require a new IRB protocol.

Plan registered on OSF by Nov 13 · Phase 2 data collected the week of Nov 16